

# 1<sup>st</sup> RCASBC INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE 2026

Rethinking Rule-Based Global Order:  
Middle and Small States  
in a Changing World

## CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

**RCAS** | 香港亞洲研究中心  
Hong Kong Research Center for Asian Studies  
Bangladesh Center (RCASBC)



Department of  
International Relations,  
University of Chittagong





**Rethinking Rule-Based Global  
Order: Middle and Small States  
in a Changing World**

## SPEECH OF THE CONVENOR

### **DR. SUJIT KUMAR DATTA**

**Convener,** 1st RCASBC International  
Conference 2026

**Professor,** Department of International  
Relations, University of Chittagong.



It is my great pleasure and privilege to welcome you to the 1st RCASBC International Conference-2026 hosted by the Hong Kong Research Center for Asian Studies (RCASBC) in collaboration with the Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh.

As the Director of RCASBC and the Convenor of this conference, I am particularly delighted that this conference marks the first major academic initiative of our Research Center. I am proud to share that scholars, researchers, academics, and experts from 24 countries, representing more than 120 universities, think tanks, and research organizations, will participate in this mega academic event. Their participation reflects the growing importance of dialogue and collaborative research on the changing global order.

I sincerely hope that this conference will go beyond academic presentations and discussions and contribute to building a long-term research network among scholars and institutions across countries. This is our start and we believe there is much more to come. I hope the academic relationships and networks developed through this initiative will lead to future research collaborations, joint publications, conferences, and other scholarly activities.

Finally, I warmly welcome all our distinguished guests, keynote speakers, scholars, researchers, and participants from Bangladesh and around the world. Your presence has made this initiative truly international, and I look forward to an inspiring, intellectually enriching, and memorable conference.



**Rethinking Rule-Based Global  
Order: Middle and Small States  
in a Changing World**

## SPEECH OF THE MEMBER SECRETARY

### **MD. NIAZ MORSHED**

**Member Secretary,** 1st RCASBC  
International Conference 2026

**Chairman,** Department of International  
Relations, University of Chittagong.



It is my great pleasure to welcome scholars, researchers, practitioners, and participants to the 1st RCASBC International Conference 2026, jointly organized by the Hong Kong Research Center for Asian Studies–Bangladesh Center (RCASBC) and the Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

This conference marks a significant milestone in the academic journey of our Department. It is the first conference of this nature and scale specifically dedicated to International Relations organized by the Department and, to the best of my knowledge, represents one of the most significant international conferences in the field of International Relations. I hope that the scholarly contributions presented here will stimulate further research, enrich academic dialogue, and foster meaningful intellectual exchange among scholars and practitioners.

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to the members of the Organizing Committee, reviewers from different universities and faculties, my esteemed colleagues, the University Administration, dedicated volunteers, and the Chittagong University International Relations Society (CUIRS) for their invaluable cooperation, commitment, and contributions to the successful organization of this conference. I wish the conference a fruitful and intellectually stimulating exchange of ideas and look forward to its continued contribution to International Relations.

# PROGRAM SCHEDULE

13<sup>TH</sup> SEPTEMBER, 2026

## Registration Starts

8:30 AM–9:25 AM

## Opening Ceremony and Inauguration of the Conference

9:30 AM –10:45 AM

National Anthem

Guests take their seats

Welcome Speech by the Convener, Professor Dr. Sujit Kumar Datta

Speech by Professor Dr. Muhammad Faridul Alam

Speech by Professor Dr. Md. Kamal Uddin

Speech by Professor Dr. Md. Enayet Ullah Patwary, Dean of Social Science

Speech by Professor Dr. Md. Safiqul Islam, Pro-Vice Chancellor (Admin.)

Speech by Professor Dr. Mohammed Al-Amin, Pro-Vice Chancellor (Academic)

Speech by Professor Dr. Mohammad Al-Forkan, Vice Chancellor

Inauguration of the Conference by the Vice Chancellor

Speech by the Member Secretary Md. Niaz Morshed

## Photo Session

10:45 AM–11:00 AM (Venue: Auditorium)

## Keynote Session – I

11:00 AM–12:00 PM

Keynote Speaker-I:

**Admiral Prof. Jayanath Colombage**

Former Navy Chief, Sri Lankan Navy.

**Paper:** Maritime Security and Regional Stability in the Indian Ocean:  
Challenges and Opportunities in a Changing Global Order

Keynote Speaker-II:

**Dr. Purna Bahadur Karki**

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Institute of Global Studies, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, Tokyo

**Paper:** Human Security at the Margins: South Asian Middle and Small States in a Fragmenting Global Order

# PROGRAM SCHEDULE

13<sup>TH</sup> SEPTEMBER, 2026

Chair:

**Prof. Dr. Md. Kamal Uddin**

Former Pro-VC (Administration), University of Chittagong.

Discussant:

**Prof. Dr. Shahab Enam Khan**

Professor, Department of International Relations, Jahangirnagar University, Bangladesh.

## Keynote Session – II

12:00 PM – 1:00 PM

Keynote Speaker-I:

**Prof. Dr. Md. Faridul Alam**

Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh.

**Paper:** Denial of Rohingyas from the Origin: Role of Host Country and the International Community

Keynote Speaker-II:

**Prof. Dr. Shahab Enam Khan**

Professor, Department of International Relations, Jahangirnagar University, Bangladesh.

**Paper:** Alignment Without Alliance: Transactional Multipolarity in a Post-Regional South Asia

Chair:

**Prof. Doctor Jayanath Colombage**

Former Navy Chief, Sri Lankan Navy.

Discussant:

**Prof. Dr. Md. Kamal Uddin**

Former Pro-VC (Administration), University of Chittagong.

# PROGRAM SCHEDULE

13<sup>TH</sup> SEPTEMBER, 2026

## **Lunch and Prayer**

1:00 PM – 2:00 PM

## **Afternoon Shift**

### **Paper Presentation Session – I**

*2:00 PM – 3:00 PM*

Will be conducted parallelly in the designated venue.

### **Tea Break**

*3:00 PM – 3:15 PM*

### **Paper Presentation Session – II**

*3:15 PM – 4:15 PM*

Will be conducted parallelly in the designated venue.

### **Paper Presentation Session – III**

*4:15 PM – 5:15 PM*

Will be conducted parallelly in the designated venue.

### **Closing for Day – I**

*5:30 PM*

# PROGRAM SCHEDULE

14<sup>TH</sup> SEPTEMBER, 2026

## Registration Starts

9:00 AM–9:30 AM

## Keynote Session – III

09:30 AM–10:45 PM

### Keynote Speaker-I:

**Ambassador M. Humayun Kabir**

Former Ambassador of Bangladesh to the United States, Ambassador to Nepal, and High Commissioner to Australia and New Zealand.

Paper: Decline of Rule Based International Order and Promotion of Bangladesh Interest.

### Keynote Speaker-II:

**Prof. Dr. Delwar Hossain**

Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Dhaka, Bangladesh

Paper: International Relations in a Changing World: Interrogating 'Singularity' and 'Otherness'

### Chair:

**Prof. Dr. Md. Abdul Mannan**

Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Dhaka, Bangladesh

### Discussant:

**Prof. Dr. Md. Faridul Alam**

Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh.

## Snacks Break

10:45 AM – 11:00 AM

# PROGRAM SCHEDULE

14<sup>TH</sup> SEPTEMBER, 2026

## Keynote Session – IV

10:45 AM–12:00 PM

### Keynote Speaker-I:

**Prof. Dr. Imtiaz A. Hussain**

Professor, Independent University, Bangladesh (IUB), Bangladesh.

**Paper:** Geo-politics, geo-economics, & the Bay of Bengal: Rippling Rohingya spillovers

### Keynote Speaker-II:

**Prof. Dr. Md. Kamal Uddin**

Former Pro-VC (Administration), University of Chittagong.

**Paper:** Rethinking Environmental Governance for Sustainable Development in the Global South: Insights from Bangladesh

### Keynote Speaker-III:

**Bartın Gomes**

Country Head, Good Neighbours Bangladesh.

**Paper:** Assessing the Impact of Good Neighbors Bangladesh's Youth Development Initiatives on Human Security and Community Resilience

### Chair:

**Prof. Dr. Nasir Uddin**

Professor, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong.

### Discussant:

**Ambassador M. Humayun Kabir**

Former Ambassador of Bangladesh to the United States, Ambassador to Nepal, and High Commissioner to Australia and New Zealand.

# PROGRAM SCHEDULE

14<sup>TH</sup> SEPTEMBER, 2026

## Keynote Session – V

12:00 PM–1:00 PM

Keynote Speaker-I:

**Prof. Dr. Safiqul Islam**

Pro-Vice Chancellor (Administration), University of Chittagong,  
Bangladesh

**Paper:** The Non-traditional Security Threats of the Bangladesh Maritime zone in the Bay of Bengal.

Keynote Speaker-II:

**Prof. Dr. Md. Abdul Mannan**

Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Dhaka,  
Bangladesh

**Paper:** Geopolitical Uncertainty, Domestic Weakness and Bangladesh's National Security

Chair:

**Prof. Dr. Delwar Hossain**

Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Dhaka,  
Bangladesh

Discussant:

**Prof. Dr. Nasir Uddin**

Professor, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong.

## Lunch and Prayer

1:00 PM – 2:00 PM

# PROGRAM SCHEDULE

14<sup>TH</sup> SEPTEMBER, 2026

## Afternoon Shift

### Paper Presentation Session - I

02:00 PM - 03:00 PM

Will be conducted parallelly in the designated venue.

### Tea Break

03:00 PM - 03:15 PM

### Paper Presentation Session - II

03:15 PM - 04:45 PM

Will be conducted parallelly in the designated venue.

### Break

04:45 PM - 05:00 PM

### Closing Ceremony, Best Paper Awards & Vote of Thanks

05:00 PM - 06:00 PM



# IN-PERSON PRESENTATIONS

**RCAS** | 香港亞洲研究中心  
Hong Kong Research Center for Asian Studies  
Bangladesh Center (RCASBC)

**13-14**  
**September 2026**



Department of  
International Relations,  
University of Chittagong

## **Session 01 on Rethinking Global Order: The Role of Middle and Small States**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Auditorium, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Md. Kamal Uddin, PhD**, Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Mohammad Sahid Ullah**, Professor, Department of Communication and Journalism, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-17**

Educational Sovereignty in a Fragmenting Order: Artificial Intelligence, Knowledge Dependence, and Small-State Agency in Bangladesh

**Authors : Md. Fajlay Rabbi, Sourav Adhikary**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-31**

Can Small States Influence Global Governance? A Study of Bangladesh's Climate Diplomacy

**Authors : Israt Jahan Isue**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-64**

Sustainable Finance as Soft Power: ESG Regulation and the Repositioning of Middle and Small States in the Rule-Based Global Order

**Authors : Afroza Sultana, Monir Ahmmed**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-78**

Reforming Global Governance for the 21st Century: Challenges and Opportunities

**Authors : Dr. Nibedita Roy**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-125**

The Climate Justice Deficit Index (CJDI): A Transparent, Reproducible Framework for Measuring the Gap Between Climate Vulnerability and Climate Finance

**Authors : Md Saazid Bin Saif, Mahin Bin Marfath**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-132**

From Hedging to Strategic Autonomy: Assessing Bangladesh's Foreign-Policy Agency amid Great-Power Competition

**Authors : Nazmul Hasan Raz, Shammi Islam**

## **Session 02 on Rethinking Global Order: The Role of Middle and Small States**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Auditorium, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Mohammad Sahid Ullah**, Professor, Communication and Journalism, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Nibedita Roy**, Associate Professor, Department of Political Science, Jagannath University, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-133**

Beyond Strategic Hedging: Bangladesh as a Constrained Agent in the US-China-India Rivalry

**Authors : Al Amin**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-183**

From Vulnerability To Welfare Power: Small-State Diplomacy, Social Protection And Economic Resilience In Bangladesh

**Authors : Mst Ruhita Rahman Tanha, Nazifa Nawar Eshika**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-192**

Grassroots to Global: Evaluating Public and Youth Perspectives on Women in Peacekeeping as Bangladesh's Soft Power

**Authors : Atasy Aranya, Mayeesha Ibnath, Atkia Maysha Amin**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-211**

From Cultural Performance to Soft Power: Reimagining Bangladesh's Film as Instrument of Cultural Diplomacy in a Changing Global Order

**Authors : Md. Saddam Hossain**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-293**

Algeria and Palestine: Settler colonialism, resistance, and the politics of liberation

**Authors : Sadiya Inam**

## **Session 03 on Rethinking Global Order: The Role of Middle and Small States**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 04:00 pm – 05:00 pm

Venue: Auditorium, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Nibedita Roy**, Associate Professor, Department of Political Science, Jagannath University, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Taslima Aktar**, Associate Professor, Department of Political Science, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-242**

THE POWER TO SAY NO Commitment-Level Exit Capacity in Bangladesh's Development-Finance Partnerships

**Authors : Nerob Ahmed**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-244**

A Shift in Small State Diplomacy in a Changing International Order

**Authors : Arusha Benta Amir, Iqra Islam Jol**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-251**

Rethinking Small State Agency: Indian MNCs, Sustainability Governance, and Bangladesh's Strategic Options in a Shifting Global Order

**Authors : Jarin Subha Sara Moni, Dorjoy Acharjee, Dr. Muslima Zahan**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-260**

Agency of Small State in International Relations: Strategic Autonomy and Bangladesh

**Authors : Dr. Sariful Islam**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-286**

From Brain Drain to Transnational Power: Bangladeshi Students in Global North Universities as Agents of Soft Power and Economic Development

**Authors : Tasnia Rubayet**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-379**

Human-Centred Digital Sovereignty: Perceptions of AI, Data Control, and Governance among University Students in Bangladesh

**Authors : Fatima Akter**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-296**

Women Diaspora in the Gulf: Contributions, Challenges, and Policy Implications

**Authors : MD Arif, Sadiya Inam**

## **Session 04 on Geo-Politics and Regional Security**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Conference Room, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Muhammad Faridul Alam**, Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Md. Mohi Uddin**, Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-34**

Media Framing and Geopolitical Contestation during Bangladesh's July Revolution: A Comparative Analysis of Western and Indian News Coverage

**Authors :** Labiba Marzuka Mahee, Md. Zahid Hasan

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-79**

The Bay of Bengal as an Emerging Maritime Chokepoint: Bangladesh's Hedging Strategy Amid Indo-Pacific Great Power Competition

**Authors :** C.A.M. Al Wahi, Tanin Bushra Ali

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-115**

Geopolitical Risk and Energy Imports: Does Government Effectiveness Matter?

**Authors :** Joshim Uddin, Myne Uddin, Jahirul Islam

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-131**

Bangladesh in the Indo-Pacific Strategic Environment: Managing Opportunity and Pressure as a Mid-Ranking State

**Authors :** A.N.M. Saif Uddin

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-142**

Maritime Vulnerability and National Food Security: Assessing the Impact of Strategic Chokepoint Disruptions on Bangladesh's Agricultural Supply Chains.

**Authors :** G.M Sifat Iqbal, Hussain Ahmed, Tafhim Rob Chowdhury

## **Session 05 on Geo-Politics and Regional Security**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Conference Room, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Muhammad Faridul Alam**, Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Md. Mohi Uddin**, Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-145**

The Boomerang Effect of Omnibalancing: Regime Security and the Collapse of the Sheikh Hasina Regime in Bangladesh (2009-2024)

**Authors : Md. Asad Ullah All Masum**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-190**

US-China Strategic Competition in the Taiwan Strait: Implications for Indo-Pacific Maritime Security

**Authors : Fatema Zannat Samiha**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-234**

The Changing Dynamics of Post-Cold War World Order, Regional Security, and Bangladesh Politics: An Overview

**Authors : Tama Rani Mistry, Reshmin Akther, Tarana-E-Tarannum Sumaiya**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-306**

The Role of BIMSTEC in Shaping Regional Geopolitics

**Authors : Dr. Md. Shayeed Hossain**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-129**

From Passive Hedging to Strategic Agency: Bangladesh amid U.S.–China–India Rivalry

**Authors : H. M. Sabbir Hossain**

## **Session 06 on Geo-Politics and Regional Security**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 04:00 pm – 05:00 pm

Venue: Conference Room, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Muhammad Faridul Alam**, Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Md. Mohi Uddin**, Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-328**

From the Himalayas to the Gulf: Chinese Engagement and Shifting Geopolitics between South and West Asia'

**Authors : Rebeka Ahmed**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-339**

The role of geopolitics and developing states in the Strait of Hormuz

**Authors : Shushil Kabir Miazi, Sohalia Bashir Shifa**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-343**

The Northern Sea Route and Reconstruction of Mackinder's Heartland Theory

**Authors : Mohammed Nabil Ahsan, Joyanti Shil, Arpon Chowdhury**

## **Session 07 on Digital Sovereignty: Technology, AI, and Global Governance**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 601, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Admiral (Prof.) Jayanath Colombage**, Former Chief of the Navy, Sri Lanka

Discussant: **Dr. Mohammad Mohiuddin**, Associate Professor, Department of Sociology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-19**

AI-Generated Political Reels on Facebook: A Comprehensive Analysis During the Rise of Generative AI Use in Bangladesh

**Authors : Md. Jahirul Islam**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-38**

The Geopolitics of Algorithmic Power and Epistemic Hegemony: A Digital Sovereignty Framework

**Authors : Shafin Muhammad John**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-87**

Online Gambling Platforms and the Coloniality of Digital Extraction: The Case of Bangladesh

**Authors : Jubayer Hossain, Mayasha Afrose Mithila**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-97**

Transforming Remittances into Sustainable Economic Stability: Exploring the Role of Digital Financial Literacy and Entrepreneurship Development among Migrant Families

**Authors : Harun Ar-Rashid Mamun, Abdur Rahim**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-102**

Hedging Against Cyber Hegemony: South Asia's Quest for Cyber Autonomy

**Authors : Ashiqur Rahman, Shaila Solaiman**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-460**

Metageopolitics of Artificial Intelligence: Assessing Bangladesh's Digital Sovereignty amid Sino-US Competition

**Authors : Masrur Mahmud Khan**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-358**

Perceptions on the moral use of Artificial Intelligence and the digital divide among AI users in Bangladeshi university students for academic purposes: Quantitative and Kantian analysis.

**Authors : Md. Najemul Alam, Akir Hossen Sumon**

## **Session 08 on Digital Sovereignty: Technology, AI, and Global Governance**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 601, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Admiral (Prof.) Jayanath Colombage**, Former Chief of the Navy, Sri Lanka

Discussant: **Dr. Md Shariful Islam**, Associate Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Rajshahi, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-113**

Algorithmic Bias and the Right to Equality: Legal Challenges of AI Governance in Developing Countries  
Algorithmic Bias and the Right to Equality: Legal Challenges of AI Governance in Developing Countries

**Authors : Aparajita Chowdhury**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-174**

SOVEREIGN-AI: A Computational Framework for Measuring and Stress-Testing National AI Sovereignty in the Global South

**Authors : Protik Das**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-175**

Detecting the Unfamiliar: Locally Trainable AI Intrusion Detection and the Limits of Digital Sovereignty for Small States

**Authors : Nirzor Chowdhury, Dr. Sandeep Gurung**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-191**

Rethinking Digital Sovereignty: Essential Digital Utilities, UN Frameworks, and Localized AI for Small and Medium States

**Authors : Mohammad Taifur Rahman**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-195**

Legitimacy Challenges of Artificial Intelligence in Global Governance

**Authors : Shohanur Rahman Shuvo**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-201**

Can States Control What They Cannot Produce? Digital Sovereignty under Technological Dependence in Bangladesh.

**Authors : Angel Hossain Emon**

## **Session 09 on Digital Sovereignty: Technology, AI, and Global Governance**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 04:00 pm – 05:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 601, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Admiral (Prof.) Jayanath Colombage**, Former Chief of the Navy, Sri Lanka

Discussant: **Dr. Md Shariful Islam**, Associate Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Rajshahi, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-223**

Governing Artificial Intelligence in a Small-State Context: Digital Sovereignty, Regulatory Capacity, and Responsible AI in Bangladesh

**Authors :** Md. Tasin Kadir, Md. Nazim, Farjana Sharmin Anika, Anika Akter Aki, Rahikul Makhtum

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-226**

Federated Intelligence for Digital Sovereignty: A Privacy-Preserving Intrusion Detection Framework for Distributed Banking Infrastructure

**Authors :** Protik Das, Md. Rakibul Islam, Iftekhar Hossen Jihad

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-229**

Digital Sovereignty and Trust in AI-Enabled e-Tax Systems: A Primary Data Study of Privacy, Security, and Algorithmic Governance in Bangladesh

**Authors :** Al Abdullah, Prof. Dr Kazi Abdul Mannan

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-240**

The Politics of Digital Repression and Backfire Dynamics: A Comparative Analysis of South Asian Uprisings

**Authors :** Pratik Roy Shanta, Nafizul Islam

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-254**

Rethinking Digital Sovereignty: A holistic governance framework for South Asian middle and small states to safeguard civilian digital rights against AI generated deepfake disinformation.

**Authors :** Rehnuma Tabassum, K.M. Ihteshamul Hoque

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-231**

Exploring the Perceptions of Cybersecurity and Cyber Harassment among Public Universities Students in Modern Age: A Study on Selected Public Universities of Bangladesh

**Authors :** Sumaiya Sharmin Shimo, Jeba Tahseen

## **Session 10 on Human Security and Climate Diplomacy**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 603, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Purna Bahadur Karki**, Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Institute of Global Studies, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, Japan

Discussant: **Dr. Taslima Aktar**, Associate Professor, Department of Political Science, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-33**

Beyond the Silos: Climate-Induced Security Risks and Inter-Agency Coordination in Small and Middle States

**Authors : Shaad Warsi**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-93**

A Voice Designed to Serve: Gendered Design and the Social Sustainability of AI in 'Isle-Adam's The Future Eve

**Authors : Afiya Jahin Esha**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-107**

Climate Change, Displacement and the Criminalisation of Survival: A Human Security Perspective

**Authors : Md. Mehedi Hasan, Mojammel Hossen Rumman, Galib Safatul Huda, S M Shafeeul Islam**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-119**

Agriculture and Human Security in Bangladesh: Emerging Challenges and Future Pathways

**Authors : Jiban Krishna Biswas**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-123**

Rohingya refugee crisis: Community perspectives and comparative global experiences

**Authors : Mohammed Rejaul Karim, Mohammed Mamun Rashid, Md Anamul Hoque**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-124**

Human Insecurity among Climate Migrants in Khulna City: Implications for Climate Diplomacy and Urban Governance

**Authors : Seemanto Das, Khondoker Mahmud Parvez**

## **Session 11 on Human Security and Climate Diplomacy**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 603, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Purna Bahadur Karki**, Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Institute of Global Studies, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, Japan

Discussant: **Md. Matiul Hoque Masud**, PhD Candidate, International Relations, American University, USA

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-128**

Economic Insecurity and Household Resilience in Chattogram, Bangladesh:  
A Human Security Perspective on the Cost-of-Living Crisis

**Authors :** Tahmina Ahmad Tasnia

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-134**

Human Security and Climate Diplomacy: Strengthening Community  
Resilience and Climate Adaptation in Disaster-Prone Bangladesh

**Authors :** Md. Nayem Hossen, Md Mojahedul Islam Emon

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-137**

The Impact of Flood and River Erosion on Household Savings Behavior: A  
Microeconomic Study on Households Settled on the Jamuna Riverbank,  
Pabna, Bangladesh

**Authors :** Md. Pias Hossain, Kazi Newaz Mostafa

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-138**

Gendering Bangladesh's Blue Economy: Women's Participation in Maritime  
Environmental Governance

**Authors :** Atia Ibnat Rifah, Azizul Hakim Rakib, Parimal Kumar Roy

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-143**

Green Banking as a Catalyst for Sustainable Development: Mapping the  
Contribution of Bangladeshi Banks to the SDGs and Climate Action

**Authors :** Richard Sagor Mitra, Dr. Abhishek Mendiratta, Dr. Sujata Umesh Bolake

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-146**

The Human Cost of Climate Change: Resilience, Health and Economics in  
Bangladesh

**Authors :** Dr. Md. Ahsan Habib, Dr. Liton Baron Sikder, Md. Abdullah Al Mabud

## **Session 12 on Human Security and Climate Diplomacy**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 04:00 pm – 05:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 603, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Purna Bahadur Karki**, Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Institute of Global Studies, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, Japan

Discussant: **Md. Matiul Hoque Masud**, PhD Candidate, International Relations, American University, USA

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-155**

Vulnerability as Leverage: Bangladesh's Dual Track Climate Diplomacy in the Bay of Bengal and Global Governance

**Authors :** Proshanti Rana Rojoni, Tanvir Hossain, Nafisa Tasnim

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-162**

Climate Change as the Defining Human Security Threat of the Twenty-First Century: Displacement and Vulnerability in Bangladesh and South Asia

**Authors :** Jannatul Adon

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-171**

The Politics of Exclusion and Genocide: Understanding Rohingya Statelessness and Cross-border Forced Migration from Myanmar

**Authors :** Dr. Mohammad Mohiuddin

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-179**

Beyond Policy Frameworks: Environmental Constitutionalism and TWAIL Perspectives on Climate Governance in Bangladesh

**Authors :** Rabaya Hossain, Tanvir Ahmed Tusher

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-182**

Salinity Hazards and Human Security: Assessing Water Security and College Infrastructure in the Sundarbans Fringe, Bangladesh

**Authors :** Md. Abu Raihan

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-184**

Can Clean Energy Access Reduce Income Inequality? The Role of Natural Resource Dependence in Asia

**Authors :** Jannatul Nayem Naisha, Myne Uddin, Mymuna Akter Nipu

## **Session 13 on New Perspectives on International Relations**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 605, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Professor Dr. Kh. Lutful Elahi**, Professor, Department of History, Jahangirnagar University, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Md. Arifur Rahman**, Research Fellow, East China Normal University, Shanghai, China

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-109**

International Cooperation for Blue Economy Development: Opportunities and Future Pathways for Bangladesh

**Authors : Md. Shariful Islam**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-241**

Cultural Diplomacy and Soft Power in South Asia: Re-evaluating Historical Perso-Bengali Relations in a Changing Global Order

**Authors : Mizanur Rahman, Md. Abu Salah**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-261**

Evolving Dynamics of Bangladesh-USA Relations (2001-2024)

**Authors : Shuravy Zaman Moonmoon**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-390**

Content Creators as Digital Diplomats: Rethinking Public Diplomacy in the Age of Influencer Politics

**Authors : Nishat Jahan Nowshin, Afshara Tasneem Zoa**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-396**

Indigenous Diplomacy as International Relations: Transnational Networks and Alternative Governance in Southeast Asia

**Authors : Md. Foysal Ahmmed Tusher, Sudip Sen Gupta Arka**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-255**

How theatre festivals can help in cultural diplomacy

**Authors : Roshan Kumar Yadav**

## **Session 14 on Digital Sovereignty: Technology, AI, and Global Governance**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 605, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Md. Arifur Rahman**, Research Fellow, East China Normal University, Shanghai, China

Discussant: **Sabbir Mahmud Shibli**, Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-267**

Evaluating Customer Satisfaction in Bangladesh's E-Commerce Sector: The Role of AI Integration, Data Privacy, and Digital Sovereignty at Daraz Limited

**Authors : Steve Oscar D Rozario, Shafaitun Nahar, Naima Nazneen Chowdhury**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-282**

The Impact of Generative AI Literacy on Career Readiness among Business Students in Bangladesh: The Mediating Role of Digital Competence

**Authors : Kazi Sadia Sultana Nishat, Maliha Intisa, Shameema Ferdousy**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-294**

Algorithmic Diplomacy and Digital Sovereignty: Rethinking Diplomatic Strategies for Middle and Small States

**Authors : Durjoy Barua**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-307**

Digital Dependency and Sovereignty at Stake: How Technological Standards Are Reshaping Foreign Policy Choices of Small States

**Authors : Ramim Hossain, Jannatun Nayeem, Mariya Islam**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-320**

Sovereignty in the Cloud: Public Perception, Digital Trust, and AI Governance in Bangladesh

**Authors : Atasy Aranya, Md. Jihad Ali**

## **Session 15 on Human Security and Climate Diplomacy**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 04:00 pm – 05:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 605, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Professor Dr. Md. Ashrafuzzaman**, Chairman, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Shaila Solaiman**, Associate Professor, Department of International Relations, Bangladesh University of Professionals (BUP), Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-196**

Awareness, experiences and expectations of Bangladeshi low-skilled migrant workers in Gulf countries regarding the diplomatic services

**Authors : Shahriare Ibne Hasan Nehal**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-209**

When Disasters Cross Borders: Bangladesh-India Flood Diplomacy and the Human Security of Border Communities

**Authors : Azizul Hakim Rakib, Atia Ibnat Rifah, Atkia Anjum Fariha**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-222**

Gendered Vulnerability to Climate Change: Role of Non-State Actors in Community-Led Climate Adaptation Plans in Hatiya, Bangladesh

**Authors : Aysa Siddika**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-224**

Understanding Environmental Degradation as a Human Rights Concern: Groundwater Depletion in Tanor Upazila, Rajshahi (Barind Tract) Bangladesh

**Authors : Nousin Islam, Md. Bariul Islam**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-232**

Beyond the 99% Recovery: How Programmable CBDCs Can Break the Climate-Debt Trap in Bangladesh

**Authors : Dorjoy Acharjee, Mir Istiak Uddin**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-239**

Governance Accountability and Water Justice: A Qualitative Case Study of the Buriganga River, Bangladesh

**Authors : Israt Jahan Tithy, Israt Jahan , Farzana Nusrat**

## **Session 16 on Open Panel: Covers all aspects of Social Sciences**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 607, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Shaila Solaiman**, Associate Professor, Department of International Relations, Bangladesh University of Professionals (BUP), Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Hanif Miah**, Associate Professor, Department of Sociology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-20**

Uncounted Learning Loss: Educational Interruption in Bangladesh's Climate Adaptation Planning and Loss and Damage Claims

**Authors :** Md. Limon Sheikh, Md. Fajlay Rabbi, Md. Sefatul Islam

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-30**

Society and Ethics in Persian Literature: A critical overview

**Authors :** Md. Akib

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-96**

Negotiating Gender, Moral Order, and Emotional Labor in Transnational Labor Migrant Households: A Study in Rural Bangladesh

**Authors :** Jubayer Hossain

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-126**

Foreign Exchange Regulation and Trade Competitiveness in Emerging Economies: Lessons for Bangladesh from Comparative Policy Experiences

**Authors :** Sifat Mahmudul Islam

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-160**

Forms of Cyberviolence Against Female University Students in Bangladesh: An Exploratory Study

**Authors :** Farjana Hridy, Md Mostafizur Rahman

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-161**

Blue Economy Implementation Challenges in Bangladesh: Maritime Diplomacy and International Marine Technology Cooperation for Sustainable Economic Development

**Authors :** Ridoy Das, Md Badrul Islam

## **Session 17 on Open Panel: Covers all aspects of Social Sciences**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 607, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Shaila Solaiman**, Associate Professor, Department of International Relations, Bangladesh University of Professionals (BUP), Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Hanif Miah**, Associate Professor, Department of Sociology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-168**

From Legal Inclusion to Reparative Inclusion: Post-Statelessness Citizenship and Uneven Development in Bangladesh's Former Enclaves

**Authors : Md Mahmudul Hasan**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-189**

A Theoretical Review of Political Gender Stereotypes and Voter Behaviors: Bangladesh Perspective

**Authors : Ummey Habiba**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-199**

Negotiating Bishnupriya Manipuri Identity through Everyday Cultural Practices: An Ethnographic Study in Shimultala, Moulvibazar, Sylhet, Bangladesh.

**Authors : Nazrul Islam, Md. Likhon**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-221**

The Chittagong Hill Tracts Accord 1997: Road to peace or conflict? A Public Policy and peacebuilding analysis of accord implementation.

**Authors : Tuhin Chakma**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-408**

Access, Assurance, and Compliance Friction in Formal Mobile-Wallet Remittance Adoption: Evidence from Bangladeshi Migrants

**Authors : Md. Mahamudul Hasan**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-446**

AI Adoption and Critical Thinking Among Bangladeshi University Students: Using the TPB Model

**Authors : Md. Mahamudul Hasan, Mahtab Uddin Mahim, Tanvir Ahamed Mahi**

## **Session 18 on Open Panel: Covers all aspects of Social Sciences**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 04:00 pm – 05:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 607, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Hanif Miah**, Associate Professor, Department of Sociology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Md. Arifur Rahman**, Research Fellow, East China Normal University, Shanghai, China

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-263**

Bridging the Digital Consumer Rights Protection Gap : The E-Commerce Regulatory Framework of Bangladesh in the Light of International Law

**Authors : Tanzila Ahmed, Najmul Alam Ashik**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-265**

Forming Marital Intimacy and Household Standing through Smartphones: Early Separated Wives of International Migrant Workers in Kishoreganj, Bangladesh

**Authors : Saugat Sharmin Setu**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-275**

Paralyzed Peace: Overcoming UN Deadlocks in Humanitarian Crises

**Authors : Meheru Mashtura Rahman**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-288**

The Social Effect of Blue Economy on Coastal Communities: Case of Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh.

**Authors : Asma Akter Akhy**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-302**

A Comparative Study on Representation of Rohingya and Gaza Crises in Bangladeshi Media

**Authors : Tasnuva Khaled Niha**

## **Session 22 on Rethinking Global Order: The Role of Middle and Small States**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Auditorium, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Md Shahidulla Kaiser**, Associate Professor, Department of Public Administration, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Dilara Zahid**, Associate Professor, Institute of Disaster Management and Vulnerability Studies, University of Dhaka, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-323**

Confucianism as Third Eye: An Analytical Lens on People Centric Approach of China's Global Governance Initiative in Bangladesh

**Authors : Sharif Noorjahan**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-335**

Beyond Hedging: Asymmetric Leverage and the Restructuring of Multilateral Governance by Small and Middle Powers

**Authors : Md. Faisal Mahmud, Anisha Islam Raisa**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-338**

Estimating the Trade Cost of Preference Erosion: A Gravity Model Analysis of Bangladesh's LDC Graduation

**Authors : Jobayed Hasan Ovi**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-354**

U.S.-China Rivalry: Impact on Bangladesh's Foreign Policy and Coping Mechanisms

**Authors : Riazul Islam Ripon**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-387**

Decision-Consequence Asymmetry and the Agency of Small States in a Changing Global Order

**Authors : Kazi Shabira Siddiqa Mariam Tondramoni**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-397**

The "Bengali" Narrative as an Instrument of Statelessness: Myanmar's Citizenship Regime, the Rohingya Identity Dispute, and Implications for Bangladesh's Security and Refugee Governance

**Authors : Aiman Noor Sadia Chowdhury, Towfique Ahmed**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-419**

Corporate Geopolitics and Techno-Dependency: Challenges to the Strategic Autonomy of Medium-Sized and Small States

**Authors : Anmon Rahman**

## **Session 23 on Rethinking Global Order: The Role of Middle and Small States**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Auditorium, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Muhammad Kazim Nur Sohad**, PhD, Associate Professor, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Nibedita Roy**, Associate Professor, Department of Political Science, Jagannath University, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-322**

Reconfiguring Global Power: The Sino-Islamic Axis and the Contestation of American Hegemony in a Multipolar World

**Authors : Sadia Eskander Mukta**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-402**

Borderlands of Exclusion: Geo-Psychological Liminality, Non-Traditional Security, and the Strategic Dilemmas of Middle and Small States in the Bengal-Arakan Shatter Zone

**Authors : Tania Ahmed Uma**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-427**

Neither Washington Nor Beijing: Bangladesh's Semiconductor Strategy in the Chip War

**Authors : Nafiz Akib Khan, Mohammad Kaiba Hasnat, Nishat Jahan Nowshin**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-444**

From "String of Pearls" to "Necklace of Diamonds": Reassessing India's Maritime Strategy and the Agency of Small States in the Indian Ocean Region

**Authors : Suruchi Sharma**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-451**

Sovereignty Beyond Consent: Security Dependence, Strategic Autonomy, and the International Legal Position of Small African States

**Authors : Syed Moin Hossain Orchy**

## **Session 23 on Rethinking Global Order: The Role of Middle and Small States**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Auditorium, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-468**

Is American Superpower Declining? Contemporary Exploration of Decadence and Rising Landscape of USA and China

**Authors** : Khan Mehedi Hasan, Meheub Hassan, Gourab Dutta

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-471**

Supply Chain Resilience as a Pathway to Strategic Autonomy in Small and Middle States: A Systematic Review of Geopolitical Disruptions, Strategies, and Outcomes

**Authors** : Dr. Md. Mizanur Rahman Chowdhury, MD Shakhawat Chy Sajid, Reshmi Akter

## **Session 24 on Geo-Politics and Regional Security**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Conference Room, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Professor Dr. Rakiba Nabi**, Chairman, Department of Law, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **A. G. M. Niaz Uddin**, Associate Professor, Department of Political Science, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-359**

Manufacturing the "Infiltrator": Media Securitization of Cross-Border Mobility and Regional Security in South Asia

**Authors : Oyshy Enayet**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-361**

From Tariffs to Strategic Competition: The Discursive Construction of the U.S.-China Trade War, 2017–2025

**Authors : Rabeya Sultana**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-363**

Geo-Psychology, Statelessness and Regional Security of Border Regions in the Rohingya Crisis

**Authors : Tania Ahmed Uma, Mahamid Hosen Mahi**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-372**

Maritime Security Cooperation in the Malacca Strait and Its Transferable Lessons for the Bay of Bengal

**Authors : Anton Chakma, Rifah Tasfia Ishadi, Zonayer Ahammed**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-375**

The Undaunted Delta: Rethinking Bengal's Politico-Military Culture from Antiquity to Contemporary Bangladesh's Strategic Culture

**Authors : Reazul Mostafa**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-376**

Iranian Cultural Influence and the Geopolitics of Iran-US Relations: A Historical Analysis

**Authors : Dr. Mojammel Huq, Shafayet Ullah**

## **Session 25 on Geo-Politics and Regional Security**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Conference Room, Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Professor Dr. Rakiba Nabi**, Chairman, Department of Law, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **A. G. M. Niaz Uddin**, Associate Professor, Department of Political Science, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-352**

Bangladesh's Maritime Interests in a Changing Global Order: From Blue Economy to Strategic Autonomy

**Authors : Abid Hasan Joy**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-384**

Operation 1027 in Myanmar: Revisiting Bangladesh's traditional security apparatus

**Authors : Tahsin Binte Hasan, Dr Razia Sultana**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-400**

From Shared Spaces to Divided Borders: Partition and the Making of Illicit Economies in Bangladesh

**Authors : Asif Mahmud, Md Shakhawat Hossain, Mojammel Hossen Rumman**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-403**

China's Rise as a Global Superpower: Strategies of International Influence and Pressure

**Authors : Md. Nahid Hasan, Nishat Jahan**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-412**

Beyond Bilateralism: Can Multitrack Diplomacy Overcome the Challenges in Water Management between Bangladesh and India?

**Authors : Md Rahatul Mowla Rahat, Md.Badrul Islam, Mahammad Sohel**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-442**

Bangladesh's New Radar Infrastructure and Airspace Security in the Bay of Bengal

**Authors : Mohammad Kaiba Hasnat, Nafiz Akib Khan, Afshara Tasneem Zoa**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-344**

Geopolitics of Energy in the Bay of Bengal: Demystifying the Evolving Trilateral Competition for Energy Resources Between Bangladesh, India, and Myanmar.

**Authors : Md. Jahidul Hasan Nayan, Md. Saiful Islam**

## **Session 26 on Digital Sovereignty: Technology, AI, and Global Governance**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 601, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Professor Dr. Md. Ashrafuzzaman**, Chairman, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Afzalur Rahman**, Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-329**

Artificial Intelligence Governance in Bangladesh: Navigating Global Standards and National Priorities

**Authors : Ayesha Akter Tumpa, Md. Rezaur Rahman, Nusrat Jahan Jothi**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-337**

Digital Sovereignty in the Global South: Bangladesh and the Challenges of AI Governance

**Authors : Sarmita Chakma, Sayma Maliha, Sheikh Himel**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-347**

Technological Soft Power: State of Cyber Security and Human Rights of Bangladesh

**Authors : Munni Akhi, Sharif Noorjahan**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-48**

Digital Sovereignty at the Margins: Reframing AI Governance for Small and Middle States through Bangladesh's National AI Policy Trajectory

**Authors : Syeda Rafia Ahmed Ishika**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-212**

Drivers and Barriers of IoT Based GPS Fleet Tracking Adoption: Managerial Decision Making in Bangladesh's Logistics Sector

**Authors : Sumiya Binta Afsar, Fairiza Islam, Md. Iestiaque Alam**

## **Session 27 on Digital Sovereignty: Technology, AI, and Global Governance**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 601, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. S M Sadat al Sajib**, Associate Professor, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Professor Dr. Md. Ashrafuzzaman**, Chairman, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-270**

Sovereignty on Lease: Compute Dependence and the Enforcement Gap in Middle-Income Digital Governance

**Authors :** Tanvir Ahmed, Sharmin Jahan Shithy, Shahriar Sadib

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-380**

Small States, Digital Dependence, and Sovereignty: Challenges in the Emerging Digital Order

**Authors :** Md Abdul Jabbar Abdullah, Muhammd Mustafiz, Yeakut Fatemi

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-389**

Financial Cyber Warfare and State Sovereignty: Revisiting the Bangladesh Bank Reserve Heist a Decade Later

**Authors :** Afshara Tasneem Zoa, Md Golam Mubasshir Rafi, Nishat Jahan Nowshin

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-394**

The renewed technological reliance of global south: The revival of structural dependency in the age of green technology

**Authors :** Md. Mohidur Hassan Moin

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-409**

The interconnection between Artificial intelligence and Political Propaganda on Social Media in Bangladesh: Challenges for Democratic Governance.

**Authors :** Samarpita Gain

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-333**

Automated Decisions, Constitutional Silence: Algorithmic Accountability Gaps in Bangladesh's Data Protection Act, 2026

**Authors :** Md Jihad Ali, Atasy Aranya

## **Session 28 on Human Security and Climate Diplomacy**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 603, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Joydeb Garai**, Associate Professor, Department of Sociology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Jiban Krishna Biswas**, Former Director General, Bangladesh Rice Research Institute

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-245**

Beyond Sovereignty: A Human Security and Gender-Sensitive Analysis of the Teesta River Dispute in Bangladesh-India Relations

**Authors :** Md. Abdul Kader, Tahira Mehjabin, Rukaya Zaman

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-256**

Beyond LDC Status: Bangladesh's Energy Transition and Small-State Climate Diplomacy After Graduation

**Authors :** Sidratul Muntaha

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-271**

The Broker as Adaptation Policy: Recruitment Debt, Gendered Migration, and the Hidden Ledger of Climate Loss in Coastal Bangladesh

**Authors :** Tanvir Ahmed, Sharmin Jahan Shithy, Shahriar Sadib

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-280**

Climate Change Interferes with Traditional Knowledge, Which in Turn Adversely Affects Human Security

**Authors :** Tapas Ranjan Chakraborty, Anusree Ghosh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-284**

Policy Implementer to Strategic Policy Proposer: Bangladesh's Way Forward Beyond Compliance in the Governance of Bioprospecting Under Nagoya Protocol

**Authors :** Tahsin Imtiaz, Dipta Debnath

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-291**

Beyond Migrant Smuggling: A Stage-Based Analysis of the Bangladesh-Libya-Italy Irregular Migration Route as a Transnational and Organized Crime Ecosystem

**Authors :** Md. Mahamudur Al Saharear Akash, Prakash Chandra Roy

## **Session 29 on Human Security and Climate Diplomacy**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 603, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Joydeb Garai**, Associate Professor, Department of Sociology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Md. Matiul Hoque Masud**, PhD Candidate, International Relations, American University, USA

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-300**

Institutional Bottlenecks in Water Governance: Addressing Challenges to Drought Resilience and Safe Water Access in Northwestern Bangladesh

**Authors : Annisa Shahid**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-318**

Digitalisation, Energy Use, Energy Intensity, and Economic and Structural Drivers of Carbon Emissions in South Asia: Evidence from a Panel ARDL Approach

**Authors : Md. Roni Ahmed, Afrina Sultana, Sumaiya Amreen Akhand**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-321**

A Systematic Review on How Climate Policy Assumptions Impact Gender Inequality in Bangladesh

**Authors : Anika Tahsin Sami**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-378**

Navigating Climate Diplomacy in the Bay of Bengal: Planetary Realism and Bangladesh's Approach to Maritime Environmental Governance

**Authors : Tahsin Binte Hasan, Dr Sufia Khanom, Jannatul Ferdous**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-418**

Investigating Women's Economic Security and Empowerment Amid Everyday Discrimination: A Conservation of Resources Perspective

**Authors : Kazi Sakiya Tabassum, Md. Sahidur Rahman**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-227**

Minerals, Margins, and Middle Powers: Bangladesh's Strategic Positioning in the Global Rare Earth Rivalry

**Authors : Aishwarya Sanjukta Roy Proma**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-391**

Green Colonialism and the Global South: Critical Minerals and Rare Earth Elements Extraction in the Age of Energy Transition

**Authors : Misbah Uddin, Tanvir Alam Rifat**

## **Session 30 on Geo-Politics and Regional Security**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 607, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Helal Uddin Ahmmed**, Associate Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Muhammad Kazim Nur Sohad, PhD**, Associate Professor, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-454**

Values and Realpolitik: A Comparative Study of U.S. Foreign Policy Towards Bangladesh Under Democrat and Republican Administrations

**Authors :** Farhana Khan Juthy, Helal Uddin Ahmmed

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-457**

Nuclear Deterrence and Big Brother Behaviour: India-Pakistan Rivalry and Its Implications for Small States in South Asia

**Authors :** Meherun Nessa, Nasrin Akter Mitu, Sajuti Mahata

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-461**

Settled Borders, Moving Seas: Who Owns the Bay of Bengal When Geography Changes?

**Authors :** Fawje Ferdous Millat Ramisa, Bibi Khadiza

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-472**

Geopolitical Risk and Economic Performance: Evidence from Southeast Asian Countries

**Authors :** Md. Nezum Uddin, Mohammed Rakibul Hasan, Mohammed Jashim Uddin

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-464**

The Digital Truth Architecture: The Importance of Policy Development and Implementation in Countering Sensationalism in Bangladesh's Online News Media

**Authors :** Prashanta Kumar Shill, Barsha Dey

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-465**

Small-State Digital Sovereignty from Below: The Legitimacy Paradox of Platform Regulation and Gen Z Counter-Power in Nepal, 2023-2025

**Authors :** Tahmida Khanam

## **Session 31 on Human Security and Climate Diplomacy**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 607, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Helal Uddin Ahmmed**, Associate Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Aditi Chakrovorty**, Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-422**

Women's Health And Climate Constitutionalism: Strengthening Legal Framework With Gender Consideration In Bangladesh

**Authors : Syed Tanvir Azam Taif, Nishat Tasnim**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-430**

Displacement, Identity Crisis, and Cultural Security: A Policy Analysis of Bangladesh's Vanishing Rengmitca Community

**Authors : Emu Moni**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-438**

Scrutinizing Climate Vulnerability: Human Security Rhetoric and Its Legal Limits in Bangladesh's Climate Diplomacy

**Authors : Khadijatul Kubra**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-441**

Migration Trends in Bangladesh: Historical Perspectives and Their Impacts on Environmental Change, Administrative Reform, and Sustainability

**Authors : Ektiar Uddin Mahmud Baktiar, Dr. Kh. Lutful Elahi, Md. Abdul Kader**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-445**

Monsoon Floods and Dry Season Scarcity: An Environmental Justice Perceived on Bangladesh-India Water Sharing

**Authors : Israt Jahan, Md Rahatul Mowla Rahat, Mahammad Sohel**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-450**

Post-COVID-19 Mental Health Challenges among University Students

**Authors : Md Mahabube Alahi, Md. Touhiduzzaman**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-466**

From Educational Vulnerability to Educational Security in Climate-Vulnerable Coastal Regions: A Systematic Review through Human Security and Climate Justice Lenses

**Authors : Dilara Zahid, Tahmina Hoq**

## **Session 32 on Open Panel: Covers all aspects of Social Sciences**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 605, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. S M Sadat al Sajib**, Associate Professor, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Purna Bahadur Karki**, Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Institute of Global Studies, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, Japan

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-447**

Limitations and Challenges of Admiralty Court in Bangladesh

**Authors : Khadijatul Kubra**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-469**

Chinese and Western Discourses on Military Artificial Intelligence: A Comparative Review through Regime Complexity Theory

**Authors : Dr Md Arifur Rahman**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-381**

The Politics of Promise in Post-2024 Bangladesh: The Expectation-Reality Gap and Authoritarian Risk

**Authors : Md. Ibrahim Ali Raju, Md. Monir Hossin, Nupur Khanom**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-164**

What explains the variation in refugee return?

**Authors : Md Matiul Hoque Masud**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-334**

From Initial Cultural Challenges to Campus Belonging: A Process Model of Identity Reconstruction through Everyday Interaction among University Students

**Authors : Roksana Ahmed Riya, Shahab Uddin**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-257**

Beyond Migration Numbers: Mapping the Migration-Remittance Disconnect in Bangladesh

**Authors : Ms. Rifah Tasfia Ishadi, Mst. Jannatun Ferdous Tima, Jannatun Noor Nafisa, M Abeedur Rahman, Zonayer Ahammed**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-258**

TruthWeb: a Holistic 4-Point Program towards the Sustainable Reconstruction of a Socially, Politically, Economically Democratic Nation – A Case Study in Bangladesh

**Authors : Hossain Md Jihad Turjo, Kazi Farzana Hossain Rimi, Jarin Subha Sara Moni, Jannatul Adon.**

## **Session 33 on Open Panel: Covers all aspects of Social Sciences**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Room no. – 605, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Dr. Purna Bahadur Karki**, Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Institute of Global Studies, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, Japan

Discussant: **Sabbir Mahmud Shibli**, Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-420**

Gendered Vulnerabilities and Policy Gaps in Bangladesh's Gig Economy: The Case of Women Workers

**Authors : Sumiya Akter, Fatema Nur Mehjabeen, Sadia Afrin Anika, Tasnia Tanha**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-463**

Structural Exploitation and Livelihood Vulnerability: Studying The Perpetuation of the Wage Gap & Its Impact on Bangladeshi Tea Labourers

**Authors : Adhiraj Datta**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-315**

AI in Policing and Global Security: Chances, Hurdles and Ethical Suggestions for Developing Countries

**Authors : Min Mukit Bin Mredul**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-332**

Digitalization, Industrial Labor Share, and Productivity: Heterogeneity across South Asian Economies

**Authors : Hridoy Das, Md. Roni Ahmed**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-473**

Media Representation and Public Perception of Extrajudicial Killings in Bangladesh

**Authors : Mahmudul Hasnat Mahi**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-474**

Building Capable States: A Comparative Analysis of Public Service Motivation in Civil Service Recruitment in Bangladesh, Rwanda, and the UK.

**Authors : Md. Ijaz Mahmud**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-273**

Japanese Popular Culture in Bangladesh: A PLS-SEM Analysis of Manga Consumption and Cultural Diffusion

**Authors : Zonayer Ahammed, Rufaida Ansaria, Taskia Newaz Mim, M Abeedur Rahman, Md Ashiqur Rahman, Ruba Rummana**



# ONLINE PRESENTATIONS

**RCAS** | 香港亞洲研究中心  
Hong Kong Research Center for Asian Studies  
Bangladesh Center (RCASBC)

| **13-14**  
**September 2026**



Department of  
International Relations,  
University of Chittagong

## **Session 19: All Panels Combined**

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Conference Room, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Afzalur Rahman**, Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. S M Sadat al Sajib**, Associate Professor, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-23**

The Geopolitical Significance of Central Asia in Shaping Regional Power Dynamics

**Authors : Dasanayaka**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-28**

Beyond Buffer-State Logic: Node-Based Agency in the Caspian-Middle East Conflict Network

**Authors : Shaoyuan Wu**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-36**

Strategic Autonomy and Coalition-Building: How Middle and Small States Are Reshaping Global Governance in a Multipolar Order

**Authors : Asmatwali**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-56**

Towards Multiplexity: Foreign Policy Evolution Beyond Exclusive Alignment—The Case of Bangladesh

**Authors : Sukanya Chakraborty**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-60**

Connectivity Power: How Middle States Are Reshaping the Rule-Based Global Order

**Authors : Fozia Hafeez**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-62**

Climate Change, Human Security, and Statelessness: Rethinking Climate Diplomacy through the Rohingya Refugee Crisis in South Asia

**Authors : Arijit Biswas**

## Session 20: All Panels Combined

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Conference Room, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Afzalur Rahman**, Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. S M Sadat al Sajib**, Associate Professor, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-63**

Digital Sovereignty and the Monetary Resilience of Small States in a Fragmenting Global Order

**Authors : Pralhad Giri**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-84**

Beyond Westphalian Sovereignty: The Emergence of Algorithmic Sovereignty and the Reimagining of International Order in the Age of Artificial Intelligence

**Authors : Prof. Dr. S V Damodar Reddy, Chingireddy Sony**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-108**

Exploring the North–South divide in the Global Carbon Market System

**Authors : Shlok Samant**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-151**

Power vs. Law at Sea: A Comparative Study of China–Philippines and India–Bangladesh Maritime Dispute

**Authors : Iffat Jahan Sharmin**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-166**

China's Expansionist Policies in the South China Sea: Threats and Responses in the Context of India's Maritime Security

**Authors : Ms. Ashu, Dr. Manju Kundu**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-167**

Indo–Bangladesh Relations in the Post–Sheikh Hasina Era: Rethinking Regional Security amid Great Power Competition

**Authors : Aditya Raj Kanaujia, Prosun Roy**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-336**

The Mecca Joint Defense Agreement: Implications for India–Pakistan Security Competition

**Authors : Sayed Anwar, Rukaya Zaman, Sajuti Mahata**

## Session 21: All Panels Combined

Date: 13th September, 2026

Time: 04:00 pm – 05:00 pm

Venue: Conference Room, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Afzalur Rahman**, Assistant Professor, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. S M Sadat al Sajib**, Associate Professor, Department of Anthropology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-220**

Economic Resilience and Strategic Autonomy: Bangladesh's Development Challenges in the Context of India-China Competition

**Authors : Dr. Badri Prasad Dash, Dr. M. Venkataraman**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-243**

Security Narratives on Spanish Ceuta: A Cross-Country Study of Migration Framing in South and Southeast Asian Media (Bangladesh and Malaysia)

**Authors : Dale Asa Roy, Gleb Trufanov**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-258**

TruthWeb: a Holistic 4-Point Program towards the Sustainable Reconstruction of a Socially, Politically, Economically Democratic Nation – A Case Study in Bangladesh

**Authors : Hossain Md Jihad Turjo, Kazi Farzana Hossain Rimi, Jarin Subha Sara Moni, Jannatul Adon.**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-268**

Digital Sovereignty as Strategic Hedging: How Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, and Kenya Layer Chinese Digital Infrastructure in the Indian Ocean

**Authors : Dr Vithiyapathy Purushothaman**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-274**

Deepfake Evidence, Real Convictions: Rethinking Criminal Procedure in the Age of Synthetic Media

**Authors : Dr. Surbhi Wadhwa**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-287**

The Multi-alignment Strategy of Middle Powers in Fragmented Global Order

**Authors : Sidra Shaukat**

**Paper : RCASBC-2026-159**

BRICS Expansion and the New Politics of Coalition-Building: Realigning the Emerging International Order

**Authors : Dhruvajyoti Roy**

## Session 34: All Panels Combined

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 02:00 pm – 03:00 pm

Venue: Conference Room, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Professor Dr. Masud Kamal**, Professor, Department of Sociology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Mohammad Mohiuddin**, Associate Professor, Department of Sociology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-314**

A Middle-Power Regime for Verifying Military AI in a Declining Rules-Based Order

**Authors** : Joonho Choi, Yesun Kim

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-341**

Hybrid Warfare in the Indo-Pacific: China's Grey Zone Strategy and India's Security Response

**Authors** : Bhawna Bhansali, Kruti Hudka

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-455**

Strategic Warning in Grey-Zone Competition: Detecting Escalation in the China-Philippines South China Sea Disputes

**Authors** : Parul Trivedi

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-262**

Beijing as a Strategic Pivot: Great-Power Realignment and Bangladesh's Hedging Strategy in Asian Security

**Authors** : Abu Sayed Md. Nazmul Haider

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-326**

Two Roads to Digital Sovereignty: Declaratory and Capability-Based Hedging in South Asian Data Law

**Authors** : Ishrat Jahan Nila

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-348**

Bangladesh-China Relations and South Asian Regional Security: Strategic Autonomy amid China-India Competition

**Authors** : Sharmin Yeasmin

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-127**

The Evolution of Digital Registers among Bangladeshi University Students

**Authors** : Orpa Saha

## **Session 35: All Panels Combined**

Date: 14th September, 2026

Time: 03:00 pm – 04:00 pm

Venue: Conference Room, Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong.

Chair: **Professor Dr. Masud Kamal**, Professor, Department of Sociology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

Discussant: **Dr. Mohammad Mohiuddin**, Associate Professor, Department of Sociology, University of Chittagong, Bangladesh

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-136**

Governing the Corridor: Institutional Capacity and the Selective Regulatory Export of Migrant Worker Protection in the Bangladesh–East/Southeast Asia Labor Migration Corridor.

**Authors** : Md Zahidul Islam, Mst. Sumaia Akter, Md. Shazid Hasan

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-382**

Digital Sovereignty and Gender Based Harm: Evaluation of Bangladesh's capacity to govern AI-generated synthetic media against women within the context of transnational platforms' power

**Authors** : Tasnim Zaman, Umme Habiba Ishme, MD Imtiaj Ahmed, Samira Sifat Swarna

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-425**

When AI Reframes Experience: Generative Linguistic Mediation and the Reorganisation of Psychological Meaning

**Authors** : Nabila Rahman

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-405**

Macroeconomic Growth, Urbanization, and Digital Adoption: A Trend Analysis of Bangladesh (2017-2025)

**Authors** : Antik Chakraborty

**Paper** : **RCASBC-2026-325**

From Strained Ties to Strategic Reset: Bangladesh-India Relations under the BNP Government

**Authors** : Abeda Khatun Chowdhury, Shamsun Nahar, Sharmin Yeasmin, Nupur Khanom



## Rethinking Rule-Based Global Order: Middle and Small States in a Changing World



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The Hong Kong Research Center for Asian Studies–Bangladesh Center (RCASBC) is a research and academic institution serving as the Bangladesh branch of the Hong Kong Research Center for Asian Studies (RCAS). It was established to promote research, academic dialogue, knowledge generation, and policy-oriented engagement on issues concerning Asia and the Indo-Pacific region. The Centre began its academic and research activities in January 2024 and received formal institutional recognition from the University of Chittagong in January 2026. Its research focuses on areas including geopolitics and regional security, international relations, global governance, middle and small states, digital sovereignty and artificial intelligence, human security, climate diplomacy, and emerging issues in Asian affairs.

### About the conference

## **Rethinking Rule-Based Global Order: Middle and Small States in a Changing World**

The 1st RCASBC International Conference 2026, jointly organized by the Hong Kong Research Center for Asian Studies–Bangladesh Center (RCASBC) and the Department of International Relations, University of Chittagong, marks a significant international academic gathering under the theme “Rethinking Global Order: The Role of Middle and Small States.” The conference has received scholarly interest from 24 countries, with abstracts submitted by researchers affiliated with up to 120 institutions worldwide. With more than 200 research papers and nearly 500 scholars, researchers, and students participating, the conference provides a vibrant platform for interdisciplinary academic exchange, intellectual dialogue, and critical engagement with contemporary global and regional issues.

